



FOODIE

Online Food Ordering & Restaurant Management System

Java Servlets & JSP

Apache Tomcat 9

PostgreSQL (Neon)

JDBC

MVC Architecture

Full Project Documentation & Viva Guide

Complete walkthrough · Architecture · Database · Code · Commands · 60+ Viva Q&A

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1. Project Introduction

Foodie is a full-featured **online food-ordering and restaurant-management web application**. It lets customers browse a food menu, add items to a cart, apply discount coupons, place orders, pay (mock Cash-on-Delivery / Card / UPI), reserve dining tables, raise complaints and chat with an AI support assistant. Delivery riders pick up and deliver orders using a secure 4-digit PIN, and an administrator manages the entire platform (users, menu items, orders, tables, reservations, coupons and complaints).

The application is built as a **classic Java EE web app** using the **Servlet + JSP** model with a hand-written **JDBC data-access layer** talking to a cloud **PostgreSQL** database. It follows the **MVC (Model-View-Controller)** design pattern and the **Front-Controller** pattern (a single servlet routes every request).

Project Name	Foodie
Type	Dynamic Web Application (Java EE / Jakarta Servlet)
Architecture	MVC + Front Controller + DAO pattern
Roles	Customer (USER), Delivery Rider (RIDER), Administrator (ADMIN)
Server	Apache Tomcat 9.0 (Servlet 4.0 API)
Database	PostgreSQL hosted on Neon (serverless cloud DB)
Language	Java 21
Build	Raw <code>javac</code> — no Maven/Gradle

2. Features Overview

Actor	Capabilities
Customer (USER)	Register/login, browse & search menu, cart (add/update/remove/clear), apply coupons, checkout with COD/Card/UPI, track orders (Placed → Accepted → Picked-up → Delivered), cancel orders, rate delivered orders (1–5 ★), reserve tables (with optional dine-in food order), raise complaints, edit profile (name/phone/photo/password/email), AI chat support.

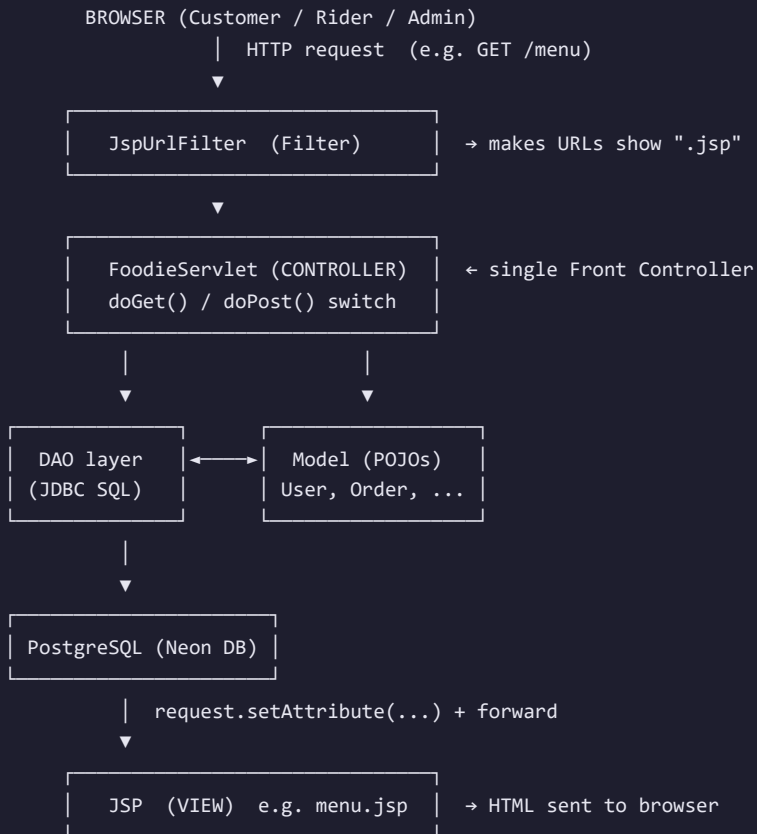
Rider (RIDER)	See accepted orders available for pickup, claim (pick up) an order, deliver by verifying the customer's 4-digit delivery PIN, view own delivery history and payment method.
Admin (ADMIN)	Dashboard with live metrics, manage users (CRUD + role/tenant), manage menu items (CRUD + image upload/URL), accept/reject orders, verify UPI payment screenshots, manage dining tables, approve/reject reservations, create/toggle/delete coupons, resolve complaints, view feedback.

3. Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Presentation (View)	JSP, HTML5, CSS3, Vanilla JavaScript	User interface, rendered server-side
Controller	Java Servlet (<code>HttpServlet</code>)	Request routing & business logic
Model	Plain Java Objects (POJOs / JavaBeans)	Data structures
Data Access	JDBC + DAO pattern	SQL persistence
Database	PostgreSQL 16 (Neon serverless)	Persistent storage
Driver	PostgreSQL JDBC <code>postgresql-42.7.4.jar</code>	Java↔DB connectivity
Server	Apache Tomcat 9.0	Servlet container
AI Support	NVIDIA NIM API (OpenAI-compatible, LLaMA-3.1-8B)	Chatbot replies
Deployment	Docker + Railway (cloud)	Containerised hosting
File upload	Servlet <code>@MultipartConfig</code>	Item & payment images

4. System Architecture (MVC)

Foodie is a textbook **Model-View-Controller** application layered on top of the **Front-Controller** and **DAO** patterns.



MVC Part	In Foodie	Responsibility
Model	<code>com.foodie.model.*</code> + <code>com.foodie.db.*</code> (DAOs)	Business data & persistence
View	<code>WEB-INF/views/*.jsp</code>	Presentation (HTML generation)
Controller	<code>com.foodie.web.FoodieServlet</code>	Receives requests, calls model, selects view

Why views live inside `WEB-INF/` : files under `WEB-INF` cannot be requested directly by a browser. This forces every page to go *through the servlet*, guaranteeing that authentication and business logic always run before a JSP renders.

5. Project Folder Structure

```
foodie/
├── WEB-INF/
│   ├── web.xml           ← Deployment descriptor (servlet & filter mappings)
│   ├── classes/          ← Compiled .class files + db.properties
│   │   └── com/foodie/...
│   ├── lib/
│   │   └── postgresql-42.7.4.jar ← JDBC driver
│   ├── src/com/foodie/    ← Java SOURCE code
│   │   ├── web/           → FoodieServlet.java, JspUrlFilter.java
│   │   ├── db/            → *Dao.java, DatabaseManager.java
│   │   ├── model/         → User, Order, Item, Coupon, ... (POJOs)
│   │   ├── chat/          → ChatService.java (AI support)
│   │   └── views/         ← JSP pages (the View layer)
│   │       ├── index.jsp, login.jsp, menu.jsp, cart.jsp, checkout.jsp ...
│   │       ├── admin/     → dashboard, users, items, orders, coupons ...
│   │       └── rider/     → dashboard.jsp
├── assets/               ← Static files (served directly)
│   ├── css/style.css
│   ├── js/script.js, theme.js
│   └── images/           → items/, payments/ (uploads land here)
├── Dockerfile            ← Container build for Railway
├── entrypoint.sh         ← Binds Tomcat to Railway's $PORT
└── railway.json          ← Railway deploy config
```

Package layout: `com.foodie.web` (controllers/filters), `com.foodie.db` (DAOs + DB connection), `com.foodie.model` (data objects), `com.foodie.chat` (AI service).

6. Request Life-Cycle — How It Works

Example: a logged-in customer clicks “Menu”.

1. Browser sends `GET /foodie/menu`.
2. `JspUrlFilter` sees a plain page GET with no extension → redirects to `/menu.jsp` (so the address bar looks like a real page).
3. `web.xml` maps both `/menu` and `/menu.jsp` to `FoodieServlet`.
4. `FoodieServlet.route()` strips the `.jsp` suffix → route key becomes `/menu`.
5. `doGet()` 's `switch` matches `case "/menu"`.
6. `ensureLoggedIn()` confirms a valid session (else redirect to `/login`).
7. `showMenu()` calls `itemDao.findAll()` → runs a `SELECT` on PostgreSQL.
8. Results are put on the request: `req.setAttribute("items", ...)`.
9. The servlet forwards to `/WEB-INF/views/menu.jsp`.
10. The JSP loops over the items list and generates HTML, which Tomcat returns to the browser.

POST-Redirect-GET (PRG): After every form POST (login, add-to-cart, place-order), the servlet responds with `res.sendRedirect(...)` instead of forwarding. This prevents the “resubmit form?” browser prompt on refresh and keeps URLs clean.

7. The Front Controller — FoodieServlet

A **single servlet handles every dynamic route**. This is the Front-Controller pattern. It extends `HttpServlet` and overrides `doGet()` and `doPost()`, each a big `switch` on the route key.

Routing helper (suffix stripping)

```
private static String route(HttpServletRequest req) {
    String path = req.getServletPath(); // e.g. "/menu.jsp"
    if (path != null && path.endsWith(".jsp")) {
        return path.substring(0, path.length() - ".jsp".length()); // "/menu"
    }
    return path;
}
```

doGet skeleton

```
protected void doGet(HttpServletRequest req, HttpServletResponse res) {
    switch (route(req)) {
        case "/login":    ... break;
        case "/menu":    if (!ensureLoggedIn(req,res)) return;
                        showMenu(req, res); return;
        case "/admin/orders":
                        if (!ensureLoggedIn(req,res)) return;
                        if (!authorizeRole(req,res,"ADMIN")) return;
                        showAdminOrders(req, res); return;
        default:         showHome(req, res, "");
    }
}
```

The `@MultipartConfig` annotation on the class enables file uploads (item images and UPI payment screenshots) with size limits — max file 5 MB, max request 20 MB.

Guard method	What it does
<code>ensureLoggedIn()</code>	Redirects to <code>/login</code> if no <code>userId</code> in session; returns boolean.
<code>authorizeRole(req,res,"ADMIN")</code>	Redirects to <code>/dashboard</code> unless the session role matches.
<code>ensureRoleInSession()</code>	Recovers the role from the DB if a session lost it.
<code>route()</code>	Normalises <code>.jsp</code> -suffixed paths back to clean route keys.

8. Clean-URL Filter — JspUrlFilter

A **Servlet Filter** mapped to `/*` (every request). Its only job is to make page URLs end in `.jsp` for display, while keeping clean routes internally.

- Only rewrites **GET** requests for pages with **no file extension**.
- Leaves static assets (`.css` , `.js` , `.png`), form POSTs, the AJAX `/chat` call, and the site root untouched.
- Sends a redirect: `/menu` → `/menu.jsp`; the servlet then strips it back.

```

public void doFilter(ServletRequest request, ServletResponse response, FilterChain chain) {
    HttpServletRequest req = (HttpServletRequest) request;
    if (shouldAppendJsp(req)) { // GET + no extension
        String q = req.getQueryString();
        res.sendRedirect(req.getContextPath() + req.getServletPath() + ".jsp"
            + (q != null ? "?" + q : ""));
        return;
    }
    chain.doFilter(request, response); // otherwise continue
}

```

9. Database Layer & Connection

Connections come from a single utility class, `DatabaseManager`. It loads the JDBC driver once in a `static` block and reads credentials from environment variables first, then falls back to `WEB-INF/classes/db.properties`.

```

public final class DatabaseManager {
    static {
        Class.forName("org.postgresql.Driver"); // load JDBC driver once
        url = firstNonBlank(System.getenv("DB_URL"), props.getProperty("db.url"));
        username = firstNonBlank(System.getenv("DB_USERNAME"), props.getProperty("db.username"));
        password = firstNonBlank(System.getenv("DB_PASSWORD"), props.getProperty("db.password"));
        ready = true;
    }
    public static Connection getConnection() throws SQLException {
        return DriverManager.getConnection(url, username, password);
    }
}

```

Self-bootstrapping schema: every DAO runs its `CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS` (and `ALTER TABLE ... ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS` migrations) inside its constructor. So the very first time the app runs, all tables are created automatically — *no manual SQL migration step*. The default admin (`admin@gmail.com` / `admin123`) is also auto-created.

db.properties (local fallback)

```

db.url=jdbc:postgresql://<host>.neon.tech:5432/neondb?sslmode=require
db.username=neondb_owner
db.password=*****
nvidia.api.url=https://integrate.api.nvidia.com/v1/chat/completions
nvidia.api.key=nvapi-*****
nvidia.model=meta/llama-3.1-8b-instruct

```

10. Database Schema (All Tables)

Nine tables, all in PostgreSQL. (The users table is deliberately named `resturent` in code.)

Table	Purpose	Key Columns
-------	---------	-------------

resturent	Users (all roles)	id, name, email(UNIQUE), password, role, tenant_id, phone, photo_url
items	Menu catalog	id, name, category, price, discount, image_path
orders	Customer orders	id, order_code, user_id, total, status, rider_id, delivery_pin, coupon_code, discount, payment_proof, rating
order_items	Line items of an order	id, order_id(FK→orders), item_id, item_name, price, quantity
restaurant_tables	Dining tables	id, table_name, shape, capacity, floor, zone, active
reservations	Table bookings	id, reservation_code, user_id, table_id, reserve_date, time_in, time_out, party_size, status, order_id
coupons	Discount codes	id, code(UNIQUE), type, value, min_order, expiry_date, active
complaints	Customer complaints	id, complaint_code, user_id, order_id, message, status, admin_reply
feedback	Public footer messages	id, name, email, message, created_at

Example — the `orders` table (DDL)

```
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS orders (
  id          SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  order_code   VARCHAR(40) UNIQUE,
  user_id     INTEGER,
  customer_name VARCHAR(255),
  tenant_id   INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1,
  address     VARCHAR(512),
  phone       VARCHAR(40),
  payment_method VARCHAR(20),
  total       NUMERIC(10,2) NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  status      VARCHAR(20) NOT NULL DEFAULT 'PENDING',
  rider_id    INTEGER,
  rider_name  VARCHAR(255),
  delivery_pin VARCHAR(4),
  table_id    INTEGER,
  table_name  VARCHAR(120),
  coupon_code  VARCHAR(40),
  discount    NUMERIC(10,2) NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  payment_proof VARCHAR(255),
  rating      INTEGER,
  created_at  TIMESTAMP DEFAULT NOW()
);

CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS order_items (
  id          SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  order_id    INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES orders(id) ON DELETE CASCADE,
  item_id     INTEGER,
  item_name   VARCHAR(255),
  price       NUMERIC(10,2) NOT NULL DEFAULT 0,
  quantity    INTEGER NOT NULL DEFAULT 1
);
```


Entity relationships

```
resturent (user) 1—∞ orders 1—∞ order_items ∞—1 items
resturent (user) 1—∞ reservations ∞—1 restaurant_tables
orders 1—0..1 reservations (dine-in link via order_id)
resturent (user) 1—∞ complaints ∞—1 orders
coupons 1—∞ orders (applied coupon_code)
```

11. DAO Classes Reference

Each DAO wraps all SQL for one table using **JDBC** with **PreparedStatement** (to prevent SQL injection) and **try-with-resources** (auto-close connections).

UserDao — table `resturent`

Method	SQL / Action
<code>findByEmail(email)</code>	<code>SELECT ... WHERE email = ?</code> — used at login
<code>emailExists(email)</code>	<code>SELECT 1 ... WHERE email = ? LIMIT 1</code>
<code>createUserWithRoleTenant(...)</code>	<code>INSERT INTO resturent</code> (name,email,password,role,tenant_id)
<code>updatePassword(email,new)</code>	<code>UPDATE ... SET password = ? WHERE email = ?</code>
<code>updateProfile / updateEmail</code>	profile edits; <code>updateEmail</code> throws if email already in use
<code>findAll / findById / deleteById /</code> <code>updateRoleTenantById</code>	admin user management

`ensureDefaultAdminUser()` guarantees `admin@gmail.com` exists with role ADMIN.

OrderDao — tables `orders` + `order_items`

Method	SQL / Action
<code>createOrder(order, lines)</code>	Transactional — insert order + batch-insert items, commit or rollback
<code>updateStatus(id, ACCEPTED)</code>	admin accept: sets status + a unique 4-digit <code>delivery_pin</code> , guarded <code>WHERE status='PENDING'</code>
<code>claimOrder(id, riderId, name)</code>	race-safe: <code>WHERE rider_id IS NULL AND status='ACCEPTED'</code> → PICKED_UP
<code>markDelivered(id, riderId, pin)</code>	<code>WHERE ... AND delivery_pin = ?</code> — PIN check is atomic in SQL
<code>cancelOrder(id, userId)</code>	customer cancel, only when PENDING/ACCEPTED
<code>rateOrder(id, userId, 1..5)</code>	only when status='DELIVERED'

<code>findAvailableForRider()</code>	<code>WHERE status='ACCEPTED' AND rider_id IS NULL</code>
<code>countByStatus(status)</code>	dashboard metrics

Order status constants: PENDING ACCEPTED PICKED_UP DELIVERED REJECTED CANCELLED

Other DAOs (summary)

DAO	Table	Notable methods / logic
ItemDao	items	<code>findAll</code> , <code>findById</code> , <code>countAll</code> , <code>createItem</code> , <code>updateItem</code> , <code>deleteById</code>
TableDao	restaurant_tables	<code>findAllActive</code> , <code>createTable</code> , <code>updateTable</code> , <code>deleteById</code>
ReservationDao	reservations	<code>isTableAvailable()</code> uses interval-overlap check; <code>create</code> , <code>cancel</code> , <code>updateStatus</code> , <code>linkOrder</code>
CouponDao	coupons	<code>findUsable(code, subtotal)</code> validates active + not-expired + min-order in one SQL query; handles duplicate code via <code>SQLState 23505</code>
ComplaintDao	complaints	<code>create</code> , <code>findById</code> , <code>resolve</code> (OPEN→RESOLVED with reply)
FeedbackDao	feedback	<code>create</code> , <code>findRecent(n)</code> , <code>countAll</code>

Typical DAO method — `PreparedStatement` + `try-with-resources`

```
public Item findById(int id) throws SQLException {
    String sql = "SELECT id,name,category,price,discount,image_path FROM items WHERE id = ?";
    try (Connection c = DatabaseManager.getConnection();
        PreparedStatement ps = c.prepareStatement(sql)) {
        ps.setInt(1, id); // ? bound safely – no SQL injection
        try (ResultSet rs = ps.executeQuery()) {
            if (rs.next()) {
                return new Item(rs.getInt("id"), rs.getString("name"), ...);
            }
        }
    }
    return null;
}
```

12. Model (POJO) Classes

Plain data classes (JavaBeans): private fields + public getters/setters + a no-arg constructor, so JSP Expression Language can read them.

Class	Represents	Interesting behaviour
User	Any account	<code>role</code> , <code>tenantId</code> , <code>phone</code> , <code>photoUrl</code>
Item	Menu dish	<code>price</code> + <code>discount%</code>
Order	An order	list of <code>OrderItem</code> , <code>deliveryPin</code> , <code>rating</code> , <code>paymentProof</code>
OrderItem	One order line	<code>getLineTotal()</code> = <code>price</code> × <code>quantity</code>
Coupon	Discount code	<code>discountFor(subtotal)</code> : PERCENT or FLAT, capped at subtotal

Reservation	Table booking	status lifecycle, optional orderId
DiningTable	Physical table	shape, capacity, floor, zone, active
Complaint / Feedback	Support messages	status, adminReply

```
// Coupon core logic
public double discountFor(double subtotal) {
    double d = PERCENT.equals(type) ? subtotal * (value / 100.0) : value;
    if (d < 0) d = 0;
    if (d > subtotal) d = subtotal; // never discount more than the bill
    return d;
}
```

13. Authentication & Role-Based Access Control

Authentication is **session-based**. On successful login the servlet stores the identity in the `HttpSession` :

```
HttpSession session = req.getSession(true);
session.setAttribute("userId", user.getId());
session.setAttribute("userName", user.getName());
session.setAttribute("userEmail", user.getEmail());
session.setAttribute("userRole", normalizedRole); // USER / RIDER / ADMIN
session.setAttribute("tenantId", user.getTenantId());
```

- **ensureLoggedIn** protects customer pages.
- **authorizeRole(..., "ADMIN"/"RIDER")** protects admin/rider pages (RBAC).
- **Logout** calls `session.invalidate()`.
- After login, the user resumes the page they were bounced from (`afterLogin`), else the dashboard.
- Customers land on `/menu`, admins on `/admin/dashboard`, riders on `/rider/dashboard`.

Honest limitation (good to mention in viva): passwords are stored as *plain text* in this student project. In production you would hash them with **BCrypt**/PBKDF2 and add a salt. This is the single biggest security improvement to name if asked.

14. Functional Modules (Deep Dive)

14.1 Cart (session-based)

The cart is a `Map<Integer, Integer>` (itemId → quantity) kept in the session — no DB writes until checkout. Actions: `add` (merge quantities), `update`, `remove`, `clear`.

```
cart.merge(itemId, qty, Integer::sum); // add: increment existing quantity
```

14.2 Checkout & Coupons

- Prices are **re-fetched from the DB** at checkout — client-side prices are never trusted.

- Applied coupons are **re-validated server-side** against the real subtotal before the order is saved.
- Payment methods: **COD, Card, UPI** (UPI requires a screenshot upload).
- On success the cart is cleared and the user is redirected to `/orders?placed=ORD...` with the receipt auto-opened.

14.3 Order Lifecycle

Customer places	→	PENDING	
Admin accepts	→	ACCEPTED	(a unique 4-digit delivery PIN is generated)
Rider picks up	→	PICKED_UP	(claimOrder: race-safe, one rider only)
Rider delivers	→	DELIVERED	(must enter the customer's correct PIN)
Admin rejects	→	REJECTED	
Customer cancels	→	CANCELLED	(only while PENDING or ACCEPTED)

Delivery PIN security: the PIN is verified inside the SQL `WHERE` clause (`markDelivered`), so a wrong PIN simply updates 0 rows — no way to bypass it from Java.

14.4 Table Reservation

Customer picks a date + time window and a table. Availability uses an **interval-overlap test** (`existing.time_in < requested.time_out AND existing.time_out > requested.time_in`). A booking can optionally continue into a **dine-in food order** (the table stands in for a delivery address).

14.5 Admin Dashboard

Aggregates live metrics: total items, total orders, counts per status, feedback count, open complaints and active coupons — all via `COUNT(*)` queries.

15. AI Chat Support Module

`ChatService` is a server-side client for **NVIDIA's OpenAI-compatible chat API** (model LLaMA-3.1-8B). The browser only ever talks to our own `POST /chat` endpoint, so the API key **never reaches the client**.

- Uses Java 11's built-in `java.net.http.HttpClient` — no external HTTP library.
- A fixed **system prompt** constrains the bot to Foodie-related help.
- Login is required; input is capped at 1000 chars.
- JSON is built and parsed by hand (no JSON library on the classpath): `jsonEscape()` and `extractContent()` .
- Never throws — returns a friendly fallback string on any failure.

```
String reply = ChatService.getInstance().reply(message);
res.getWriter().write("{\"reply\":\"" + ChatService.jsonEscape(reply) + "\"}");
```

16. Security Aspects

Concern	Mitigation in Foodie
---------	----------------------

SQL Injection	PreparedStatement with bound <code>?</code> parameters everywhere
XSS (cross-site scripting)	<code>escape()</code> HTML-encodes user text (&, <, >, ", ')
Direct JSP access	JSPs live under <code>WEB-INF/</code> → unreachable without the servlet
Broken access control	<code>authorizeRole()</code> guards every admin/rider route (RBAC)
Price / discount tampering	Prices & coupon discounts recomputed server-side from the DB
Race conditions	Status transitions guarded in SQL <code>WHERE</code> (claim, deliver, cancel)
Delivery fraud	4-digit PIN checked atomically in SQL
Secret leakage	DB & API credentials read from env vars / server-side properties, never sent to browser
Upload abuse	<code>@MultipartConfig</code> size limits (5 MB file / 20 MB request)

Known weaknesses to acknowledge: plain-text passwords, secrets committed in `db.properties`, no CSRF tokens, session-fixation not hardened. All are standard “future work” talking points.

17. Important Syntax Explained

Servlet declaration

```
public class FoodieServlet extends HttpServlet {
    protected void doGet (HttpServletRequest req, HttpServletResponse res) { ... }
    protected void doPost(HttpServletRequest req, HttpServletResponse res) { ... }
}
```

Forward vs Redirect

```
// FORWARD – server-side, same request, URL unchanged, can pass attributes
req.getRequestDispatcher("/WEB-INF/views/menu.jsp").forward(req, res);

// REDIRECT – tells browser to make a NEW request, URL changes (used after POST)
res.sendRedirect(req.getContextPath() + "/orders");
```

Session handling

```
HttpSession s = req.getSession(true); // create if none
s.setAttribute("userId", 42);
Object id = s.getAttribute("userId");
s.invalidate(); // logout
```

JDBC pattern (the “big 5”)

```
Connection con = DriverManager.getConnection(url, user, pass);
PreparedStatement ps = con.prepareStatement("SELECT * FROM items WHERE id = ?");
ps.setInt(1, id);
ResultSet rs = ps.executeQuery(); // executeUpdate() for INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE
while (rs.next()) { rs.getString("name"); }
```

JSP + Expression Language + scriptlet

```
<%@ page import="java.util.List, com.foodie.model.Item" %>
<% List<Item> items = (List<Item>) request.getAttribute("items"); %>
<% for (Item it : items) { %>
    <h3><%= it.getName() %></h3>          <!-- <%= %> prints a value -->
<% } %>
Context path via EL: ${pageContext.request.contextPath}
```

web.xml mapping

```
<servlet>
  <servlet-name>FoodieServlet</servlet-name>
  <servlet-class>com.foodie.web.FoodieServlet</servlet-class>
</servlet>
<servlet-mapping>
  <servlet-name>FoodieServlet</servlet-name>
  <url-pattern>/menu</url-pattern>
  <url-pattern>/menu.jsp</url-pattern>
</servlet-mapping>
```

18. Build, Run & Deploy Commands

Compile (no Maven/Gradle — raw javac, run from `WEB-INF/src`)

```
javac -encoding UTF-8 \
  -cp "../lib/postgresql-42.7.4.jar;<tomcat>/lib/servlet-api.jar" \
  -d ../classes \
  com/foodie/model/*.java com/foodie/db/*.java \
  com/foodie/chat/*.java com/foodie/web/*.java
```

Classes are written to `WEB-INF/classes` ; the servlet-api.jar is Tomcat's own, the Postgres driver is in `WEB-INF/lib` . All four packages must be compiled together.

Start Tomcat (Windows, JDK 21)

```
cd <tomcat>/bin
set "JAVA_HOME=C:\Program Files\Java\jdk-21.0.10"
startup.bat # (shutdown.bat to stop)
```

Hot-reload after recompiling

```
# Tomcat reloads the context when web.xml changes:
touch WEB-INF/web.xml      # recompile FIRST, then touch (~10s reload cycle)
```

Run the app

```
http://localhost:8080/foodie/      # welcome page (home)
Login: admin@gmail.com / admin123  # default admin
```

Docker / Railway deploy

```
FROM tomcat:9.0-jre21-temurin      # Dockerfile
RUN rm -rf /usr/local/tomcat/webapps/ROOT
COPY . /usr/local/tomcat/webapps/ROOT/  # serve at root context "/"
# entrypoint.sh rewrites Tomcat's port to Railway's $PORT, then runs catalina.sh
```

Handy Git commands

```
git add .
git commit -m "Add project documentation"
git push origin main
```

19. Viva Questions & Answers

A. Basics & Architecture

Q1. What is Foodie?

A Java Servlet/JSP web application for online food ordering and restaurant management, supporting three roles — customer, delivery rider and admin — backed by a PostgreSQL database.

Q2. Which design pattern does the project follow?

Primarily **MVC**. It also uses the **Front-Controller** pattern (one servlet routes all requests), the **DAO** pattern (one class per table for persistence), and the **Singleton** pattern (ChatService, DatabaseManager).

Q3. What is MVC and how is it applied here?

Model = POJOs + DAOs (`com.foodie.model / db`); View = JSP pages in `WEB-INF/views` ; Controller = `FoodieServlet` . The controller receives the request, uses the model to fetch/save data, then forwards to a view that renders HTML.

Q4. What is a Front Controller? Why use one?

A single entry-point servlet that handles every request and dispatches to the right handler. Benefits: centralised authentication, consistent routing, and no need to write a separate servlet per page.

Q5. What is a Servlet?

A Java class running inside a web container (Tomcat) that handles HTTP requests and generates responses. It extends `HttpServlet` and overrides `doGet()` / `doPost()`.

Q6. What is the Servlet life-cycle?

Three methods managed by the container: `init()` (once, on load) → `service()` (per request, dispatches to `doGet/doPost`) → `destroy()` (once, on unload). The container creates a single servlet instance and serves concurrent requests with threads.

Q7. What is JSP and how does it relate to servlets?

JSP (JavaServer Pages) is an HTML template with embedded Java. At runtime the container **compiles each JSP into a servlet**. We use JSP purely for the view layer.

Q8. Difference between forward and redirect?

Forward is server-side within the same request (URL stays the same, attributes are preserved) — used to render a JSP. **Redirect** asks the browser to issue a brand-new request (URL changes) — used after POST to implement Post-Redirect-Get.

Q9. What is the POST-Redirect-GET pattern and why use it?

After processing a POST, respond with a redirect to a GET page. This prevents duplicate form submissions when the user refreshes and keeps the browser URL clean. Foodie uses it after login, add-to-cart, checkout, etc.

Q10. What is `web.xml` ?

The deployment descriptor. It declares the servlet, the filter and all URL mappings, plus the welcome file. Foodie maps each route both cleanly (`/menu`) and with a `.jsp` suffix.

B. Database & JDBC

Q11. What is JDBC?

Java Database Connectivity — the standard API for connecting Java to relational databases and running SQL. Core objects: `Connection` , `Statement` / `PreparedStatement` , `ResultSet` .

Q12. Why PreparedStatement instead of Statement?

It pre-compiles the SQL and binds parameters with `?` , which (a) prevents **SQL injection** and (b) is faster for repeated queries. Foodie uses it for every query.

Q13. What is the DAO pattern?

Data Access Object — a class that encapsulates all database operations for one entity, so business logic never writes raw SQL. Foodie has `UserDao`, `OrderDao`, `ItemDao`, etc.

Q14. How are database tables created?

Each DAO runs `CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS` in its constructor (self-bootstrapping). New columns are added with `ALTER TABLE ... ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS` . No manual migration is needed.

Q15. Which database is used and why?

PostgreSQL, hosted on Neon (serverless cloud). It's free-tier friendly, supports SSL and works from anywhere, which suits cloud deployment on Railway.

Q16. How is the DB connection configured?

`DatabaseManager` loads the driver once in a static block and reads the URL/username/password from environment variables first, then `db.properties` . `getConnection()` returns a fresh `Connection` .

Q17. What is try-with-resources and why is it used?

A Java construct that auto-closes resources (Connection, PreparedStatement, ResultSet) at the end of the block, preventing connection leaks. Every DAO method uses it.

Q18. How does the order creation stay consistent?

`createOrder()` runs a **transaction**: it turns off auto-commit, inserts the order and all line items, then `commit()`s — or `rollback()`s on any error, so you never get an order with missing items.

Q19. What is SERIAL PRIMARY KEY ?

A PostgreSQL auto-incrementing integer primary key — the DB assigns a unique id automatically on insert.

Q20. How do you get the generated id back after an insert?

Prepare the statement with `RETURN_GENERATED_KEYS` and read it from `getGeneratedKeys()`. Foodie does this for orders, reservations and complaints.

C. Security

Q21. How is SQL injection prevented?

All SQL uses PreparedStatement with bound parameters, so user input is treated as data, never as executable SQL.

Q22. How is XSS handled?

User-supplied text is HTML-escaped by the `escape()` helper before being written into pages (converting `< > & " '`

Q23. Why are JSPs under WEB-INF?

Files under `WEB-INF` can't be opened directly by a browser. This forces every page through the servlet, so authentication and authorization always run first.

Q24. How is role-based access enforced?

The role is stored in the session at login. Admin/rider routes call `authorizeRole()`, which redirects away anyone whose session role doesn't match.

Q25. Biggest security weakness and how to fix it?

Passwords are stored in plain text. Fix by hashing with **BCrypt** (salted, slow hash) and comparing hashes at login. Also move secrets out of `db.properties` into environment variables and add CSRF tokens.

Q26. How is the delivery PIN kept secure?

It's generated uniquely when the admin accepts an order and verified inside the SQL WHERE clause on delivery — a wrong PIN updates zero rows, so it can't be bypassed in Java.

Q27. How do you stop price/coupon tampering?

The server ignores any price sent by the browser. At checkout it re-reads item prices from the DB and re-validates the coupon against the true subtotal before saving the order.

D. Features & Logic

Q28. How does the cart work?

It's a `Map<itemId, quantity>` stored in the HttpSession. Nothing is written to the DB until checkout, so it's fast and per-user.

Q29. Walk through the order lifecycle.

PENDING (placed) → ACCEPTED (admin, PIN generated) → PICKED_UP (rider claims) → DELIVERED (rider enters PIN). Alternatives: REJECTED (admin) or CANCELLED (customer, only while pending/accepted).

Q30. How is a rider stopped from claiming the same order twice?

`claimOrder()` updates `WHERE rider_id IS NULL AND status='ACCEPTED'`. Only the first rider's update succeeds; a second attempt affects zero rows.

Q31. How is table double-booking prevented?

Before booking, `isTableAvailable()` runs an interval-overlap query for the same table and date against PENDING/ACCEPTED reservations. If any overlap exists, the booking is refused.

Q32. How do coupons work?

Admins create PERCENT or FLAT coupons with an optional min-order and expiry. `findUsable()` validates active + not-expired + min-order in one SQL query; `discountFor()` computes the amount, capped at the subtotal.

Q33. What payment methods exist?

Cash on Delivery, Card, and UPI (mock). UPI additionally requires uploading a payment screenshot, which the admin later verifies.

Q34. How does file upload work?

The servlet is annotated `@MultipartConfig`. Uploaded images are saved under `assets/images/items` or `/payments` with a unique timestamped filename; the DB stores the relative path.

Q35. What is dine-in ordering?

A reservation can flow straight into a food order; the table name replaces the delivery address, and the finished order is linked back to the reservation via `linkOrder()`.

Q36. How does the AI chat work without leaking the API key?

The browser calls our own `/chat` endpoint; the server (`ChatService`) forwards the message to NVIDIA's API with the secret key held server-side and returns only the reply text as JSON.

Q37. What is a Filter and what does `Jsrfilter` do?

A Filter intercepts requests before they reach a servlet. `Jsrfilter` redirects extension-less page GETs to their `.jsp` form so the address bar shows `.jsp`, without changing any internal routing.

Q38. How are dashboard metrics computed?

With `COUNT(*)` queries per status/entity (orders by status, item count, feedback count, open complaints, active coupons), gathered in `showAdminDashboard()`.

E. Java & Tooling

Q39. What is a POJO / JavaBean?

A Plain Old Java Object with private fields, public getters/setters and a no-arg constructor. Foodie's model classes are JavaBeans so JSP EL can read their properties.

Q40. What is the Singleton pattern? Where is it used?

A class with a single shared instance. `ChatService` exposes `getInstance()`; `DatabaseManager` is effectively a static singleton (private constructor, static methods).

Q41. How is the project built without Maven?

Directly with `javac`, pointing the classpath at Tomcat's `servlet-api.jar` and the Postgres driver, compiling all four packages into `WEB-INF/classes`.

Q42. How do you deploy a new build to a running Tomcat?

Recompile the classes, then `touch WEB-INF/web.xml`; Tomcat detects the descriptor change and reloads the web-app context automatically.

Q43. What is a WAR / context path?

A WAR is a packaged web-app. The context path is the URL prefix for the app — here `/foodie` locally, or root `/` in the Docker/Railway deployment.

Q44. What does `request.setAttribute` vs a session attribute mean?

A request attribute lives for one request (used to pass data to a JSP during forward); a session attribute persists across requests for one user (used for login identity and the cart).

Q45. What is Expression Language (EL) in JSP?

A concise syntax like `${pageContext.request.contextPath}` to access objects/properties without Java scriptlets.

Q46. How does the app run in the cloud?

A Dockerfile builds a Tomcat-9-on-JRE-21 image, copies the app to the root context, and `entrypoint.sh` binds Tomcat to Railway's `$PORT`. `railway.json` configures the build and restart policy.

Q47. What are multi-tenancy hints in the schema (`tenant_id`)?

A `tenant_id` column exists on users and orders to support multiple restaurants/branches in future; currently it defaults to 1.

Q48. How would you scale or improve this project?

Add a connection pool (HikariCP), hash passwords, add CSRF protection, move secrets to env vars, introduce a service layer, add REST/JSON APIs, unit tests, and real payment-gateway integration.

Q49. Why store the delivery address as the table name for dine-in?

Because a dine-in order has no delivery address; using "Dine-in — Table X" keeps a single, uniform order schema for both delivery and dine-in.

Q50. What happens on logout?

`session.invalidate()` destroys the session (clearing identity and cart), then the user is redirected to the home page.

F. Rapid-fire one-liners

Question	Answer
Server used?	Apache Tomcat 9
Servlet API version?	4.0 (Java EE / <code>javax.servlet</code>)
Java version?	21
Database?	PostgreSQL (Neon cloud)
JDBC driver?	postgresql-42.7.4.jar

Default admin?	admin@gmail.com / admin123
Roles?	USER, RIDER, ADMIN
Cart storage?	HttpSession (Map itemId→qty)
Password storage?	Plain text (improvement: BCrypt)
Coupon types?	PERCENT, FLAT
Order statuses?	PENDING, ACCEPTED, PICKED_UP, DELIVERED, REJECTED, CANCELLED
Users table name?	<code>resturent</code> (misspelt on purpose)
AI model?	NVIDIA LLaMA-3.1-8B-instruct
Deployment?	Docker image on Railway
Build tool?	None — raw <code>javac</code>

20. Glossary of Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Servlet	Java class handling HTTP requests inside a web container
JSP	HTML template with embedded Java, compiled to a servlet
MVC	Model-View-Controller separation of concerns
Front Controller	Single servlet routing all requests
DAO	Data Access Object — class encapsulating a table's SQL
JDBC	Java Database Connectivity API
PreparedStatement	Pre-compiled parameterised SQL (prevents injection)
HttpSession	Per-user server-side state across requests
Filter	Interceptor that runs before servlets
Forward	Server-side dispatch within one request
Redirect	Browser makes a new request to a new URL
PRG	Post-Redirect-Get anti-duplicate-submit pattern
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
POJO / JavaBean	Plain data object with getters/setters
Context path	URL prefix of the deployed web-app
Deployment descriptor	<code>web.xml</code> configuration file